HINDUSTAN INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL
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Karapakkam

HIS GLOBAL CONCLAVE- EDITION 3.0

"Where Young Minds Meet to Debate, Deliberate and Lead."

ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL COUNCIL (ECOSOC)

BACKGROUND GUIDE

Agenda: Addressing Youth Unemployment through Educational Realignment

Focus: Restructuring national educational systems to teach digital literacy and vocational skills, preparing the global youth workforce for an AI-driven economy.

LETTER TO DELEGATES

Dear Delegates,

We extend our warmest regards to all delegates representing the Economic and Social Council at the HIS Global Conclave.

As HIS Global Conclave 3.0 brings delegates together, we invite you to engage with one of the most pressing socioeconomic challenges of our time: the growing need to bridge the gap between education and employment in an increasingly digital and automated world.

Education has long been recognised as a foundation for economic opportunity and social progress. However, the rapid advancement of artificial intelligence, automation, and digital technologies is transforming the nature of work across industries. While these developments present opportunities for innovation and productivity, they also raise important concerns regarding youth unemployment, unequal access to skills, and the preparedness of existing educational systems.

The Economic and Social Council serves as an important platform for international cooperation on these interconnected challenges. Through discussions aligned with Sustainable Development Goal 4 - Quality Education and Sustainable Development Goal 8 - Decent Work and Economic Growth, delegates will be encouraged to examine how education can become more inclusive, relevant, and responsive to evolving labour-market requirements.

As members of this committee, you are expected to look beyond immediate solutions and consider the long-term implications of educational reform. The challenge lies not merely in introducing technology into classrooms, but in ensuring that every young person, irrespective of geographical location or socioeconomic background, has access to the knowledge and practical skills required to participate meaningfully in the global economy.

We encourage you to approach this agenda with critical thinking, constructive diplomacy, and a willingness to understand perspectives different from your own. Through informed debate and international collaboration, we hope you will develop solutions that balance technological progress with human welfare and economic opportunity.

The Executive Board looks forward to the ideas, research, and commitment each delegate will bring to the committee.

Sincerely,

Chairperson & Vice Chairperson

ECOSOC

HISTORY OF THE COMMITTEE

ECOSOC — The Economic and Social Council

The Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) is one of the six principal organs of the United Nations, established under the United Nations Charter in 1945. Its mandate centres on promoting international cooperation in economic, social, cultural, educational, health-related, and other related fields. Through coordination, policy dialogue, and partnerships, ECOSOC works to advance improved living standards, productive employment, social progress, and respect for human rights.

ECOSOC held its first meeting in London from 23 January to 18 February 1946, under the presidency of Sir Ramaswami Mudaliar of India. Over the decades, the Council has developed into an important forum for addressing complex global development challenges. Its work connects governments, specialised agencies, civil society, the private sector, and other stakeholders in the pursuit of shared development objectives.

Education and employment are closely connected to ECOSOC's wider mandate. Access to quality education contributes to the development of human capabilities, while productive and decent employment enables individuals to participate in economic life and improve their living conditions. Nevertheless, disparities in educational opportunities, unequal access to technology, and mismatches between acquired qualifications and labour-market requirements continue to affect development outcomes across countries.

The Council also plays an important role in the follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Through its engagement with the High-Level Political Forum on Sustainable Development, the Development Cooperation Forum, and the ECOSOC Youth Forum, it provides opportunities for countries and stakeholders to assess progress, exchange experiences, and identify areas requiring further cooperation.

In the context of an AI-driven economy, ECOSOC's coordinating role is particularly relevant. The transition towards digital and technology-assisted workplaces requires education systems, employers, and governments to work together. National policies may differ according to economic conditions and institutional capacities, but international cooperation can help countries share effective practices, expand access to skills development, and support vulnerable populations.

As the global community works towards the Sustainable Development Goals, ECOSOC remains an important platform for examining how education, employment, technology, and social inclusion can be integrated into sustainable development strategies.

INTRODUCTION TO THE AGENDA

Agenda: Addressing Youth Unemployment through Educational Realignment

Restructuring National Educational Systems to Teach Digital Literacy and Vocational Skills, Preparing the Global Youth Workforce for an AI-Driven Economy

Youth unemployment remains a significant challenge to inclusive economic growth and social development. Although access to education has expanded in many parts of the world, formal education does not always lead to meaningful employment. Many young people struggle to enter the workforce due to limited work experience, inadequate practical training, unequal access to technology, or a mismatch between their qualifications and employers’ requirements.

The International Labour Organization (ILO) reported that approximately 13 per cent of the global youth labour force was unemployed in 2023. In the same year, an estimated 20.4 per cent of young people worldwide were not in employment, education, or training (NEET). These figures highlight a broader challenge: millions of young people remain disconnected from both educational opportunities and the labour market.

Meanwhile, artificial intelligence (AI) and automation are transforming employment across sectors. Although these technologies may reduce demand for certain tasks, they can also create new opportunities and increase the need for skills in areas such as data analysis, cybersecurity, and digital services. However, technological progress alone cannot guarantee decent employment. Young people must have access to relevant training, while businesses and governments must help ensure that the benefits of innovation are widely shared.

Educational realignment involves adapting national education systems to changing economic and technological needs. Key approaches include integrating digital literacy into school curricula, expanding technical and vocational education and training (TVET), strengthening apprenticeships, encouraging partnerships between educational institutions and industries, and promoting lifelong learning. Digital literacy should cover not only basic computer skills but also online safety, information evaluation, responsible AI use, and problem-solving. Vocational education must likewise be recognised as a valuable pathway to employment and further learning.

Implementing these reforms presents several challenges. Schools in underserved regions may lack reliable electricity, internet access, trained teachers, and suitable equipment. Limited public funding, gender inequality, disability-related barriers, and socioeconomic disadvantages can further restrict access to education and employment. As a result, acquiring new skills does not always guarantee a successful transition into the workforce.

The central challenge is therefore to build inclusive education systems that connect learning with decent work and remain responsive to technological change. This agenda supports **Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 4: Quality Education**, particularly Target 4.4 on developing relevant skills for employment, and **SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth**, particularly Target 8.5 on productive employment and decent work, and Target 8.6 on reducing the proportion of young people not in employment, education, or training.

The committee is invited to examine how national education systems can prepare young people for an AI-driven economy, how international cooperation can support countries with limited resources, and how technological progress

can expand employment opportunities without deepening existing inequalities. Delegates should consider practical and inclusive approaches that help young people develop relevant skills and transition successfully from education to decent work.

KEY TREATIES AND ACHIEVEMENTS

1. The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development

Adopted by all United Nations Member States in 2015, the 2030 Agenda established 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to address global challenges and promote sustainable development.

SDG 4 focuses on inclusive, equitable quality education and lifelong learning. Target 4.4 calls for young people and adults to develop relevant skills for employment, decent work, and entrepreneurship. SDG 8 promotes economic growth and decent work, with Targets 8.5 and 8.6 addressing productive employment and the reduction of youth unemployment and NEET rates.

These goals provide a shared international framework for connecting education, skills development, and employment opportunities.

Reference: United Nations — SDG 4 | SDG 8

2. The Incheon Declaration and Education 2030 Framework for Action

Adopted in 2015 at the World Education Forum, the Incheon Declaration reaffirmed the international commitment to inclusive, equitable quality education and lifelong learning. The Education 2030 Framework for Action provides guidance on implementing SDG 4 through national policies, financing, monitoring, and international cooperation.

Its emphasis on relevant skills and equal access to education makes it particularly important when considering curriculum reform, teacher training, and vocational learning.

Reference: UNESCO — Education 2030

3. The ILO's *Global Employment Trends for Youth 2024*

The International Labour Organization (ILO) examines youth employment trends and the challenges young people face when moving from education into work. Its 2024 report found that the global youth unemployment rate fell to approximately 13 per cent in 2023, its lowest level in 15 years. However,

progress varied across regions, and many young people continued to face difficulties securing stable, decent employment.

The report highlights why policymakers must look beyond unemployment rates and consider the quality of available jobs, gender disparities, and the number of young people excluded from both education and employment.

Reference: ILO — Global Employment Trends for Youth 2024

4. The Addis Ababa Action Agenda on Financing for Development

Adopted in 2015, the Addis Ababa Action Agenda established an international framework for financing sustainable development. It emphasises domestic resource mobilisation, international public finance, private investment, and development cooperation.

Its relevance to educational realignment lies in the resources required to improve school infrastructure, train teachers, expand digital access, and strengthen vocational institutions. It provides a basis for discussing how countries with limited resources can finance these reforms.

Reference: United Nations — Addis Ababa Action Agenda

5. The Global Initiative on Decent Jobs for Youth

The Global Initiative on Decent Jobs for Youth brings together UN entities and other partners to support action on youth employment. Its work recognises that improving employment opportunities requires cooperation among governments, employers, workers, educational institutions, and youth organisations.

For this agenda, the initiative highlights the importance of connecting skills training with actual labour-market opportunities and helping young people transition from education into decent work.

Reference: Global Initiative on Decent Jobs for Youth

6. The United Nations Youth Strategy — Youth 2030

Launched in 2018, Youth 2030 is the United Nations' system-wide strategy for strengthening its work with and for young people. It promotes youth participation in sustainable development, human rights, peace, and security.

The strategy is relevant to educational reform because young people should have opportunities to contribute to decisions affecting their education, digital

skills, and employment prospects. Their participation can help ensure that policies reflect the needs of different communities.

Reference: United Nations — Youth 2030

7. The ILO's Research on Generative AI and Employment

In May 2025, the ILO published *Generative AI and Jobs: A Refined Global Index of Occupational Exposure*. The study estimated that approximately one in four workers worldwide was in an occupation with some exposure to generative AI, while 3.3 per cent of global employment fell into the highest exposure category.

The study emphasises that exposure to AI does not necessarily mean that an occupation will disappear. Instead, many jobs may change as technology reshapes the tasks workers perform. This highlights the need for adaptable education systems that develop digital competence, critical thinking, and skills that can evolve alongside technological change.

Reference: ILO — Generative AI and Jobs

8. UNESCO's Work on Technical and Vocational Education and Training

UNESCO promotes technical and vocational education and training (TVET) as an important part of inclusive education and skills development. TVET helps learners gain practical, occupation-specific skills for employment, entrepreneurship, and further learning.

As industries adopt new technologies, vocational programmes may need updated equipment, trained instructors, and stronger partnerships with employers. Strengthening these programmes can help young people access a wider range of career pathways and prepare for changing workplace requirements.

Reference: UNESCO — Technical and Vocational Education and Training

9. The Global Partnership for Education

The Global Partnership for Education (GPE) supports education systems in partner countries, particularly by helping strengthen national capacity and improve access to quality education.

Its work is relevant to countries seeking to improve teacher training, school infrastructure, inclusive learning, and educational planning. International

partnerships can help address gaps in resources and expertise, particularly in communities where access to digital learning and vocational training remains limited.

Reference: Global Partnership for Education

10. The High-Level Political Forum and the ECOSOC Youth Forum

The High-Level Political Forum on Sustainable Development (HLPF) reviews progress towards the 2030 Agenda and its Sustainable Development Goals. Convened under the auspices of ECOSOC or the UN General Assembly, it provides a platform for countries to assess progress, share experiences, and discuss implementation challenges.

The ECOSOC Youth Forum provides opportunities for young people to engage with Member States and other stakeholders on sustainable development. Both platforms are relevant to this agenda: the HLPF supports the review of progress towards education and employment goals, while the Youth Forum highlights the importance of including young people's perspectives in policymaking.

References: High-Level Political Forum | ECOSOC Youth Forum

CONCLUSION

As delegates of the Economic and Social Council, you are entrusted with addressing a challenge that connects education, employment, technological progress, and social equality.

Youth unemployment cannot be solved through educational reform alone. It reflects the relationship between the skills young people acquire, the opportunities economies create, and the support available to help them transition from education to employment.

Artificial intelligence presents both opportunities and challenges. While it can drive innovation, improve productivity, and create new areas of work, unequal access to technology and relevant training may leave many young people behind. The challenge for the international community is to ensure that technological progress contributes to inclusive growth and decent employment.

As you deliberate, consider how education systems can respond to changing labour-market needs through digital literacy, vocational training, teacher development, industry partnerships, and lifelong learning. Equally important is ensuring that these opportunities remain accessible to young people from

different backgrounds and that international cooperation supports countries facing financial and infrastructural constraints.

The goal is not simply to prepare young people for the jobs that exist today, but to equip them with the skills and adaptability needed for the opportunities and challenges of tomorrow.

Through constructive dialogue, evidence-based policymaking, and international cooperation, delegates have the opportunity to shape a future in which education opens doors, technology creates opportunities, and decent work is within reach of young people across the world.

Best of luck, delegates!

Regards,
The ECOSOC Executive Board
HIS Global Conclave 3.0